



NWSA Music Hub

Why it exists · How you'll use it · Why it's less work

New World School of the Arts — Music Division

For the Dean, and the directors of Wind Ensemble, Jazz Ensemble and High School Choir

Three stops for questions — please use them.

WHAT THIS MEETING IS

Three things, then you decide

1

Why it exists

The problem it removes — not a feature list.

2

How you use it

Your ensemble, shown live on a phone.

3

Why it's faster

The structural reason, not a sales number.

When those three are done, we're done — and the rest is your questions.

THE PROBLEM

The same fact, entered four times

The problem was never that we were disorganized.

It was that every fact about this department had to be entered more than once — and the copies drifted apart.

Attendance was the worst of it. The old Notion workspace was fine on a laptop — and impossible on a phone in front of an ensemble. So roll went on paper, and got typed up later. Or never.

- 1 The calendar**
changed by hand
- 2 The parents**
told individually, all evening
- 3 The wall**
still says the old time
- 4 The students**
who weren't in the room are simply wrong

One place. Two doors.

The public site

- Students, parents, anyone
- No login. No password. No app to install.
- Today's schedule, calendar, concerts, their own schedule, their sheet music, announcements

The Director Panel

- You — signed in with Google, by invitation
- Everything above, plus the ability to change it
- Roll, roster, schedule, repertoire, documents, announcements

Same information. Same moment. There is no third place, and no export step in between.

THE ONE IDEA

You set it once. Everyone sees it.

Cancel a rehearsal in the app and you are not also posting it somewhere. The cancellation IS the notice.

the front page of the site

every affected student's schedule

the calendars people subscribed
to

One action. You don't chase it afterward.

What a family sees

- 1 A red strip, or nothing**
Anything cancelled or moved today shows at the very top. No red strip means today is normal — and that is the whole point.
- 2 Find your name once**
The site remembers that student on that device. From then on it's their rehearsals, their concerts, their part.
- 3 Two kids? Save both**
Parent mode holds several students at once.

No account.

No password.

Nothing to install.

An account is a wall. We don't need one to tell somebody when rehearsal is.

LIVE: Home → My Schedule → look up a real student by name.

Your day starts here

Ensemble

start - end time · room · how many are expected
what you're rehearsing — the pieces linked to it

✓ Roll taken — time, and by whom

the shape of every card — your real screen shows your ensembles

Underneath it, without looking anything up:

- 1 Anything cancelled or changed today
- 2 Every lesson pulling a student out
- 3 Unexcused absences nobody has dealt with
- 4 Filter to just your ensemble — it remembers

One screen. That's the morning.

You mark the exceptions. Nothing else.

Absent

Late

Excused

Lesson

Everyone else is present. You don't touch them.

A lesson isn't an absence

You give the time window and a reason — required. Now the empty chair is documented.

It watches while you work

How late they were. Their last five rehearsals, as dots. Absences a parent reported ahead. A warning if every trumpet is out.

Finish roll — summary

Who's out, one tap to call or email home, and a clean list to copy.

WHY THAT'S FASTER

80 students.
4 of them out.

4 taps

Nobody out is zero taps.

Most systems make the work grow with the size of your ensemble — eighty students, eighty marks, every day, whether or not anything happened.

Here the work grows with the number of absences — not with the size of the room.

I have not timed the old way against the new way, so I'm not claiming a number of minutes. What changed is the shape of the work — and that it finishes in the room.

Four things you get for free

1 Receipt

The event records when roll was taken, and by whom. “Did Tuesday get done?” is a glance, not a reconstruction.

2 Pattern

Each student’s last five rehearsals, as dots, right on the roll screen. A pattern is visible without looking anything up.

3 Follow-up queue

Unexcused absences from the past week collect in one place. Clear each with Excuse, Contacted, or Dismiss — a queue meant to reach empty.

4 Export

The attendance you want as a spreadsheet file, whenever somebody needs it in writing.

Questions — before I move on from roll, because it’s the thing you’ll do every day.

When the day changes

Swap two blocks

Shift a time

Move the room

Cancel it

One edit. Then, without you doing anything else:

Tagged as changed

on the event itself

Red banner

on the public front page

A notice offered

posted as an urgent
announcement

Revert to normal

The app snapshots the original before your first change, so reverting restores exactly what was there — and pulls the notice back down. You can never be stuck having damaged the calendar.

And for the day school closes: one button cancels everything on that date and posts one notice.

Borrow a student. Keep your roster.

What you do

- Add a student for one event — or for a date range
- Or pull one out for the same
- Give a reason. It's required.

It expires by itself.

What it never touches

Your permanent roster.

While it's active it is completely real: a "Sub" badge on your roll screen, the student on Who's Out for the ensemble they left, and the change on their own public schedule.

Nobody has to remember to undo anything. That is how rosters stop rotting.

Three levels — and one rule

Normal

Appears on the front page and your ensemble's page.

Important

Highlighted so it can't be scrolled past.

Urgent

A banner across every page of the site. For “call time moved” — not “bring your folder.”

And on any of them:

Pin it to the top

Give it an expiry date

Write it now, post it later

Add your own Spanish

The rule: announcements are public. Anyone can read them. Nothing private goes in one.

The program prints itself

You enter, once

- Formal title, composer and dates, arranger
- Movements, durations, program notes
- A recording, and the score
- A sheet-music link per instrument



It comes back out as

- The printed concert program — in the order you set
- A “My part” button for each student, matched to their instrument
- The piece page families can listen to before the concert

One piece can belong to several ensembles — a work Wind Ensemble and Choir both perform is one entry, not two.

ALSO IN THERE

Three more, when you want them

1

Documents

Syllabus, handbook, forms, policies — uploaded or linked, tagged to your ensemble or school-wide. Parents stop emailing you for the handbook.

2

Assignments & exams

Due dates that land on students' own schedule pages. A playing exam can carry a Google Form link, so it's submitted through the form.

3

Seating

Publish a chart after auditions — seat 1 is principal. On rehearsal day you can take roll by tapping chairs instead of reading a list.

None of this is required. Roll and the calendar carry themselves.

NONE OF THIS MATTERS IF THEY NEVER OPEN IT

Getting families in

1

Scan

The app prints a QR kit: posters for the wall, a “find my schedule” poster, one per ensemble, and sheets of slips you cut apart and staple to the front of every folder.

2

Type

Short addresses for the ones who’d rather type — /we for Wind Ensemble, /jazz, /choir.

3

Subscribe

One tap puts your ensemble’s calendar into the calendar app on a phone, and it stays current by itself.

Subscribing is the one I’d push hardest — it’s the difference between families checking, and families knowing.

Who can see what

Staff only — always

- Grade level and pronunciation guide
- Contact details for students and guardians
- Attendance records
- Progress notes
- Private lesson schedules

Public — on purpose

- Schedules and concerts
- Repertoire and programs
- Announcements
- Student name, instrument, section, ensemble

The line is enforced twice: what the public site is even allowed to ask for, and separately, by name, what fields that answer is allowed to contain. Grade never crosses it, in either direction.

Names are public so a student can find their own schedule without an account.

Grade level was never part of that trade — it stays behind sign-in with everything else on the left. That line is a decision the two of us can revisit; it isn't a default.

FOUR LEVELS OF ACCESS

Who can do what

Owner

One account. The only one that can add or remove people.

Director

Full editing everywhere except that access list. That's the three of you.

Teacher

Schedules private lessons for their own assigned students — nothing else. A clash with your rehearsal must be acknowledged, then shows on your roll screen as a documented pull-out.

Personnel Assistant

Takes roll for the ensembles you assign — and nothing else. No contact details. No grades. No notes. Every mark stamped with their name.

A student aide can take attendance for you without seeing a single phone number. Access is added or removed instantly, from inside the app.

Where it lives, what it costs

No license

No subscription, no per-seat fee. Free hosting tiers as configured today.

No server

Nothing in a closet. Nothing to back up by hand.

Rebuilds itself

The site and the calendar feeds refresh on a schedule.

Installs like an app

Add it to a home screen on a phone or iPad. It opens even on a bad connection.

Said honestly: free tiers depend on usage and on the vendors' terms. I'm not promising "free forever" — I'm telling you there's nothing to pay today.

THE EFFICIENCY ARGUMENT

Old way → new way

Before

NOW

Attendance

Written down, typed up later

Tapped once, in the room, on your phone

“Is rehearsal cancelled?”

Individual replies, all evening

One edit → a banner everyone sees

A student subbing in

Roster edited, and remembered back

Temporary, reasoned, self-reversing

The concert program

A separate document, retyped

Generated from what you already entered

Sheet music parts

Handed out, and handed out again

Linked to the piece; a student finds their own

Every fact gets entered once, by the person who knows it — and stops being re-asked.

What I'm asking of you this week

1

Sign in and look

If it says your account isn't authorized, that's my job, not yours — tell me and it's fixed in a minute.

2

Take roll in the app once

Once. If it doesn't work the way you need, I want to hear it from the first attempt — not the fortieth.

3

Check your own month

You know your schedule better than the calendar does. Tell me what's wrong on it.

4

Name one person

Anyone who should be able to take roll for you — a section leader, an aide.

I'll check back with each of you on _____.

THREE PLACES, IN ORDER

When you're stuck

1

Start Here

In the app menu. Real questions grouped by students, parents and directors — every answer links straight to the screen you need. It prints, if you want it on paper.

2

The glossary

At the bottom of that page. Call time, pull-out, sectional, principal, downbeat. Written for ninth graders and parents — useful for anybody.

3

Ask me

I'd much rather fix a confusing screen than have you work around it.

Nothing here is finished, and nothing here is precious. Every screen I showed you came from somebody saying "this doesn't work the way I work."

What did I miss?

What's going to break?

Take the time. The first question is usually the most useful one.

What I am NOT claiming today

- A measured time saving — the argument is structural, not a study
- Teams / email delivery of urgent posts — the app queues it; that hop is unverified
- That grade level is public anywhere — it isn't; only name, instrument, section and ensemble are
- That there's a help desk behind this — there's me



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Hub**

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Arts